Silverheights School Council Meeting Agenda

Date & Time: January 25, 2022, 6:30-8:30 pm (virtual only)

> *"Parents play a vital role in the development and education of their children and in the success of schools.*
> *They are the most important influence in a child's life outside of school.*
> *Long after direct learning from parents in a child's early years gives way to formal education, parents continue to play a key role in student success through the attitudes they help to share and the direct supports they provide."*
>
> Ontario Ministry of Education

School Council Summary: https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/school-councils/

School Council Handbook: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/school_council_chairpersons_handbook.pdf

Item	Agenda Item	Duration	Person(s) Responsible
1	**Welcome & Introduction** - Attendees (virtual only): Kate Davy, Alison Chong, Leah McCreight, Heather Humphrey, Amy Pharoah, Jason Stere, Tara Goudy, Ryacon Caltour, Erin Ambachtsheer, Karen, Elise Gamie, Jenn Latour - Approval of November Meeting Minutes	5 mins	Chair (Ling Tam)
2	**News**		
	Community Partnership – deferred Silverheights Neighbourhood Association - deferred www.silverheightsneighnourhood.com	5 mins	Community Rep (Regrets)
	WRAPSC – see attached	5 mins	Assembly Rep (Amy Pharoah)
	PIC - N/A	5 mins	Assembly Rep
3	**Teacher's Report - deferred**	10 mins	Teacher Rep (regrets)
4	**Principal's Report – deferred**	10 mins	Principal (Jason Stere)
5	**Equity Connection – deferred**	5 min	Vice-Principal (Tara Goudy)
6	**Financial Report** Balance = $21,822.47	10 min	Treasurer
	Grants: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/4690-School-Generated-Funds.pdf		
	PIC Grant – Great news! Grant received		
	Parents Reaching Out (PRO) Grant: See attached info & upcoming deadlines https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/parents-reaching-out-pro-grants/		

7	**2022-2023 Wish List Survey Results - deferred** (approve:decline:defer) 1) Learning materials for kindies ($1,500) = 4:1:2 2) Field trip bussing ($7,000) = 7:0:0 3) Primary class Home Reading Program ($7,000) = 6:0:2 4) Guest speakers ($2,000) = 1:5:1 5) STEM materials ($2,000) = 6:0:1 6) Athletic materials ($1,000) = 6:0:1 7) School club materials ($500) = 5:0:2 Estimated total = $21,000 Highlighed items – additional information requested before casting vote.	15 mins	Chair
8	**Council Subcommittees** In-school volunteers - # Student volunteers = 2 per class, one waiting in hall & one approaching the table (to prevent congestion) - # Parent volunteers = 4 Pizza Committee Jan 24 Event: Cheese slices = 379 Pepperoni slices = 268 Grand total = 647 slices Deposits = $1070.00 Expense = $655.99 Balance = $414.01 + $250 carryover = $664.01 - Donation Initiative was successful; some families did identify themselves as in need & there was sufficient donations to provide pizza to affected kids. Monies from these donations accumulate in the same pizza fund so there will always be surplus to purchase donation slices for each event. Julie will continue to help administer this effortl - Clarity in communication needed in School Day; include link to purchase pizza & schedule the posts/remainders on weekly frequency. - Frequency of Pizza Days: Weekly starting on Feb 7. - Online ordering: Suggestion to set up as individual events in School Day so parents can order as far in advance as they wish & can opt out on select weeks as desired. - Confirm student & parent volunteers In 3-wk or 5-wk chunks to ensure commitment. - Q: Can School Day be set up to post recurring announcements? I.e. Every Wed, post announce of next pizza day with deadlin to order on Monday. Reminder post on Monday morning to place order. Tally # on Tues. Place order with Dominos on Wed. Subcommittee to work out this timing with Julie. - Tables, pizza cart, gloves, napkins will be provided by Donna (custonian) each week & will be ready in the lobby. Notify Jason if additional supplies needed	15 mins	Subcommittee Rep

	Fundraising Committee - deferred **Special Event initiatives** - Family movie nights - Smencil sales - Community Activity Fair General inbox has been receiving emails from various community extra curricular activities. Consider restarting plans to host a community activity far?		
9	**Calendar of Planned School Events**	5 min	Council Members
10	Questions & Answer Period	5 mins	Council Members
11	Next Meeting Date:	February 22, 2023	In-person & online meet
12	Agenda Items for Next Meeting	5 mins	Council Members
13	Adjournment		

Notes:
MOE – Ontario Ministry of Education
PIC – Parent Involvement Committee (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/)
PRO – Parents Reaching Out
SCIS – Safe, Caring & Inclusive Schools
(https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/links/safe-caring-and-inclusive-schools-scis-resources/)
WRAPSC – Waterloo Region Assembly of Public School Councils
(https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/)

General Council Email: silverheightscouncil@gmail.com

WRAPSC for January 2023

School board trustees Kathleen Woodcock and Joanne Weston were present. Two student school board trustees were present: Vaishnave Raina and Kenzy Soror https://www.wrdsb.ca/trustees/student-trustees/ . Silverheights' students Grades 7-8 and other WRDSB students Grades 7-12 can participate online at the WRDSB student round table. This is a board initiative to help WRDSB understand the needs of their students. For example, the issue of the dress code was brought to the board's attention by Grade 7-8 students at a round table discussion. Students get notices via email regarding round table discussions. They can pick and choose which ones that they want to attend; there is no obligation. Student Trustee's Recommendation: School councils can help empower student voices by having their own school's students at their school council meetings.

WRAPSC Suggestions of Items we can add to our Agenda:

We can invite a community center (20% of councils have done this). We can invite an environmental outdoor program (10%) like Rare, Nature Connection, Nutritionist, registered dieticians (Andrea D'Ambrosio from Dietic Directions), a dietician from Zehrs on Ottawa St. (to give ideas on making healthy lunches for kids), or a school psychologist or a WRDSB psychologist (to discuss well-being). Some councils invited school trustees (5%) (Joanne Weston), STSWR (Student Transportation Services of Waterloo Region to discuss crosswalk initiatives), Mark Kovrig (WRDSB Facilities Supervisor), Ripple Effect, and KW Counseling.

Favourite Caregiver/Parent Topics at School Council Meetings: curriculum, fundraising, principal updates, by-laws, and WRAPSC updates.

Suggestions on how to arrange Council Meetings Differently:

A school council said they run one budget meeting per year; they ONLY discuss the budget. All other general meetings (4 per year) do not discuss the budget. Everything else not covered in the 4 general or the single budget meeting is discussed by a number of subcommittees.

PRO grant applications: They aren't available. The board has given no timeline. Key people at the board level are on leave, have left, or are too busy to answer questions by the WRAPSC chair. Our school will know how much our PRO grant will be (either $250 or $750) from our principal. He knows what our "School Equity Index" level is. Each school has a "School Equity Index" level; some schools get $250; others get $750. WRAPSC's recommendation is to have your plan in place for how to spend your PRO grant as a council because the deadline will be very tight. Also, the fewer councils that use the grant, the less money the government will choose to set aside in the future.

School Council can use WEFI for donations: Parents can donate through WEFI to a designated School Council Initiative. It just needs to be labeled ie. "School Playground."

53% of school councils are using a hybrid method (in-person and online) for their meetings. 33% in-person and 6% online only.

Ministry Grant of $500 for parent council is on the principal's budget line titled "Parent Engagement Funds." If our council doesn't use it, the principal can share his ideas with council of how to use those funds. This grant is not the same as the PRO grant.

WRAPSC encourages school councils to designate and announce what they are fundraising for before they fundraise for it.

Bullet Notes

- School board trustees Kathleen Woodcock and Joanne Weston were present
- student school board trustees were present: Vaishnave Raina and Kenzy Soror https://www.wrdsb.ca/trustees/student-trustees/
- Grades 7-12 can participate online at the WRDSB student round table
- Student Trustee's Recommendation: School councils can help empower student voices by having their own students at their school council meetings.
- WRAPSC Suggestions of Items we can add to our Agenda: community center, environmental outdoor program like Rare, Nature Connection, Nutritionist, registered dieticians (Andrea D'Ambrosio from Dietic Directions), a dietician from Zehrs on Ottawa St. (to give ideas on making healthy lunches for kids), a school psychologist or a WRDSB psychologist (to discuss well-being), school trustees (5%) (Joanne Weston), STSWR (Student Transportation Services of Waterloo Region to discuss crosswalk initiatives), Mark Kovrig (WRDSB Facilities Supervisor), Ripple Effect, and KW Counseling.
- Favourite Caregiver/Parent Topics at School Council Meetings: curriculum, fundraising, principal updates, by-laws, and WRAPSC updates.
- Suggestions on How to Arrange Council Meetings Differently: one budget meeting per year. All other general meetings (4 per year) do not discuss the budget. Everything else is discussed by a number of subcommittees.
- PRO grant applications: They aren't available.
- PRO: Each school has a "School Equity Index" level; some schools get $250; others get $750.
- Recommendation: have plan in place in advance for how to spend your PRO grant as a council because the deadline will be tight
- School Council can use WEFI for donations: Parents can donate through WEFI to a designated School Council Initiative. It just needs to be labeled ie. "School Playground."
- Half of school councils hold hybrid meetings.
- Parent Council's Ministry Grant of $500: on the principal's budget line titled "Parent Engagement Funds." If our council doesn't have any ideas, the principal can share his.
- WRAPSC encourages school councils to designate and announce what they are fundraising for before they fundraise for it.

PRO Grant application process

The application process for the 2022-23 Parents Reaching Out (PRO) Grant for School Projects is now open.

Overview
The Parents Reaching Out (PRO) Grants provides funding for school boards to work with their Parent Involvement Committee and/or school councils to lead initiatives that address local parent needs and/or remove barriers that prevent parents from participating and engaging fully in their children's learning and educational progress.

PRO funding is intended to be used by local communities to identify and address barriers to parent engagement. Projects that support the diversity of parent needs and parent communities at the local level through an equity and inclusion lens are eligible for PRO funding.

Ministry Criteria for Funding
PRO funding continues to support initiatives that remove barriers to parent engagement in their children's education. Projects that demonstrate how schools can improve in at least one of the following areas are eligible for funding:

- Addressing social inclusion and racism specifically anti-Asian, anti-Black, and anti-
    - Indigenous racism and other prejudices toward racialized and marginalized groups
- Creating a safe and welcoming environment
- Demonstrating respect for parents as valued partners within the education system regarding decisions about their child's education
- Enhancing communication with teachers
- Informing parents about the expectations of the Ontario Curriculum and supporting resources.

Examples of projects shared by PICs and Board Leads from the 2021-22 school year include but were not limited to:

- Anti-Black Racism, anti-Indigenous and anti-oppression initiatives
- Parent/caregiver engagement supports (e.g., evening conferences)
- Enhanced multi-lingual and technology support (e.g., virtual presentations, online networking)
- Food sovereignty and environment (e.g., hiking, community gardens);
- Mental health and well-being (e.g. workshops on student and family mental health)
- Physical health and wellness (e.g. Zumba)
- Providing targeted resources to meet specific parent needs so parents can be resilient (e.g., parent curriculum-briefing workshops)
- 2SLGBTQI (e.g., awareness building by offering culturally responsive experiences)
- STEM (e.g. in-person learning nights)
- Online learning software and safety (e.g., cyber-literacy); and,
- Literacy supports for parents to help their child(ren).

Ineligible Project Costs:

- Activities that took place prior to September 6, 2022
- Payment to school board staff or volunteers including salaries, honoraria, gifts

- Refreshments exceeding 10% of approved funding
- Out-of-province travel
- Debts or financial losses that result from a project
- Fundraising events
- Central administration expenses exceeding 10% of the budget

Application Process & Deadlines
The Waterloo Region District School Board will accept and evaluate PRO Grant applications. Please complete the appropriate google form application below to apply for a PRO Grant.

Elementary School PRO Grant Project - 2022-23 PRO Grant Application Form

Secondary School PRO Grant Project - 2021-22 PRO Grant Application Form

The deadline for submitting a 2022-23 PRO Grant application is ***Friday, February 24, 2023.***

PRO Grant funding allocations by school will be communicated directly to Administrators in a subsequent email.

To be eligible for PRO Grant funding, projects must be completed and expenses incurred between September 6, 2022 and June 16, 2023.

A final report is to be completed and submitted to rose_dimartino@wrdsb.ca by June 23, 2023. PRO Grant recipients are encouraged to submit their final report as soon as their project is completed.

PRO Grant Evaluation Committee includes representation from the Parent Involvement Committee, Special Education Advisory Committee, Equity and Inclusion Advisory Group and Board of Trustees.

PRO Grant School Projects must be planned to engage parents in a way that adheres to current Region of Waterloo Public Health and WRDSB COVID-19 Guidelines.

2022-23 PRO Grants Project Timelines	
January 23, 2023	PRO Grant application process distributed to schools
February 24, 2023	PRO Grant applications due
March 17, 2023	Successful applicants notified
June 23, 2023	School reports due to Board

Information on past projects can be found on the PRO Grants webpage on wrdsb.ca.

If you have any questions, please email rose_dimartino@wrdsb.ca.
We look forward to working together to support parent engagement within the WRDSB.